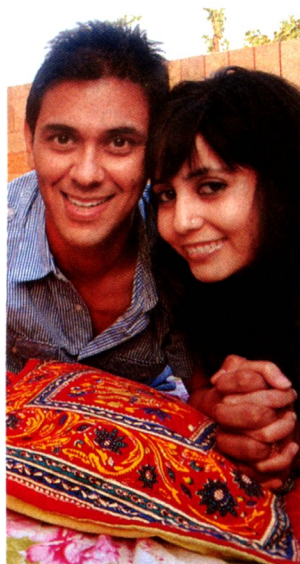




RAHIL MOHAMMED, 31, AND NIHA, 27
Delhi

WHO THEY ARE

Rahil is a captain in the Merchant Navy while Niha is a homemaker.

NIHA The thought of getting drenched under a waterfall with my partner or making out on the balcony is exciting.

RAHIL I'd like to take her to a place where there's snow all around with a bonfire on a rooftop or maybe even a candle-lit dinner in an igloo.



ABHIJIT, 39, AND SHRUTI SAHA, 35
Bangalore

WHO THEY ARE

Abhijit is a chef-entrepreneur while Shruti is a PR consultant.

ABHIJIT My romantic fantasies, apart from candle-lit dinners at restaurants overlooking the city, include being able to go to the moon.

SHRUTI My ultimate fantasy is to get married again in the traditional manner.

As told to Sumaiya Khan and Swagata Sen

Location courtesy THE PARK, NEW DELHI



How do you feel about your unfulfilled fantasies?

Would like to fulfill them 20

Sometimes feel anxious 28

Don't get too bothered 43

Rest don't know/can't say. All figures in per cent.

Sexual fantasies are crying out loud for fulfilment. Everyone seems trapped in their own personal dream world, with 43 per cent saying they don't do anything about them and another 48 per cent admitting they would like to satisfy their desires and feel upset that they can't.

refrained or were uninterested, a whopping one-third, were sexually dissatisfied.

When I met Dr Edward Laumann, one of the world's leading experts on sexuality at the University of Chicago who has spearheaded an international study of sexuality, interviewing 27,500 men and women in 30 countries, this is what he told me: Whenever men and women in a society occupy unequal ranks, not only does the aggregate sexual satisfaction dip lower for all its members, but the gap between men and women's sexual unhappiness widens, with men more sexually satisfied than women. Male-centric countries, he said, "tend to discount the relational meaning of sex and the importance of sexual pleasure for women."

In the face of such sexual unhappiness what happens when we collect sexual data on the fantasy life of individuals? A gilding-a-lily effect takes place—we embellish our responses, in turn, amplifying our fantasy. Let